ENGINEERING SOCIETY · TECHNICAL TEAM

Phase 0: Foundation

The team playbook: why we start here, who owns what, how the team learns as we build, and the checklist we work through together.

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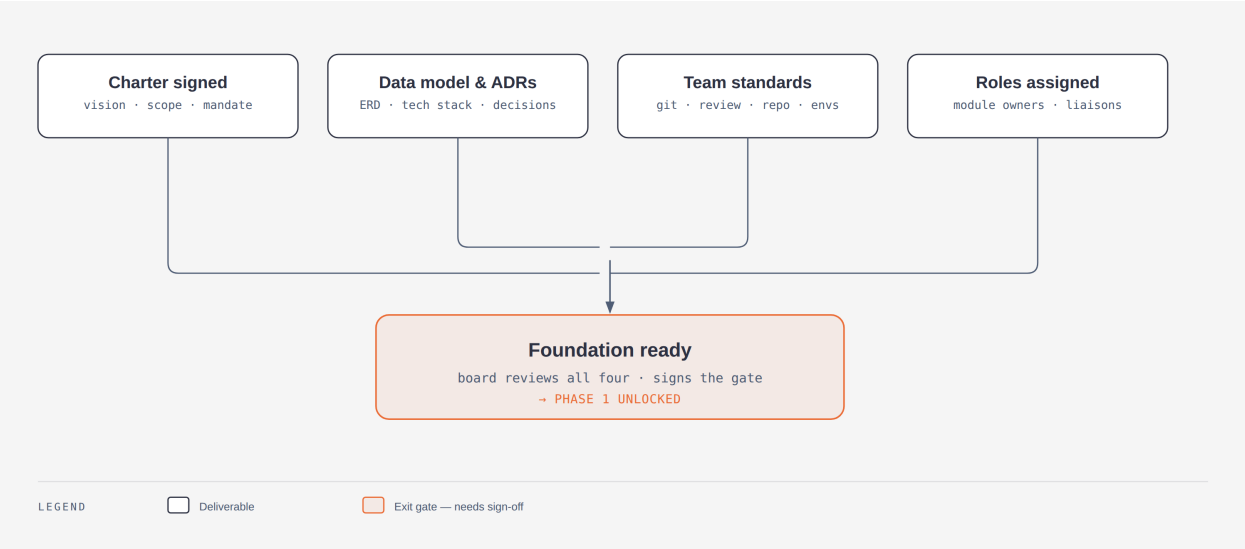
WHY THIS PHASE FIRST

Why we start here

This year, the technical team is building one platform the whole society will run on: members, events, attendance, certificates, the archive, and the graduate network all living on the same data, permanently. That only works if the foundation is built correctly once, before writing a single feature.

Phase 0 is that foundation. Nothing in Phase 1 (member registration and event registration) starts until Phase 0 is done. This isn't bureaucracy, it's what stops us from rebuilding the same thing twice.

What Phase 0 delivers

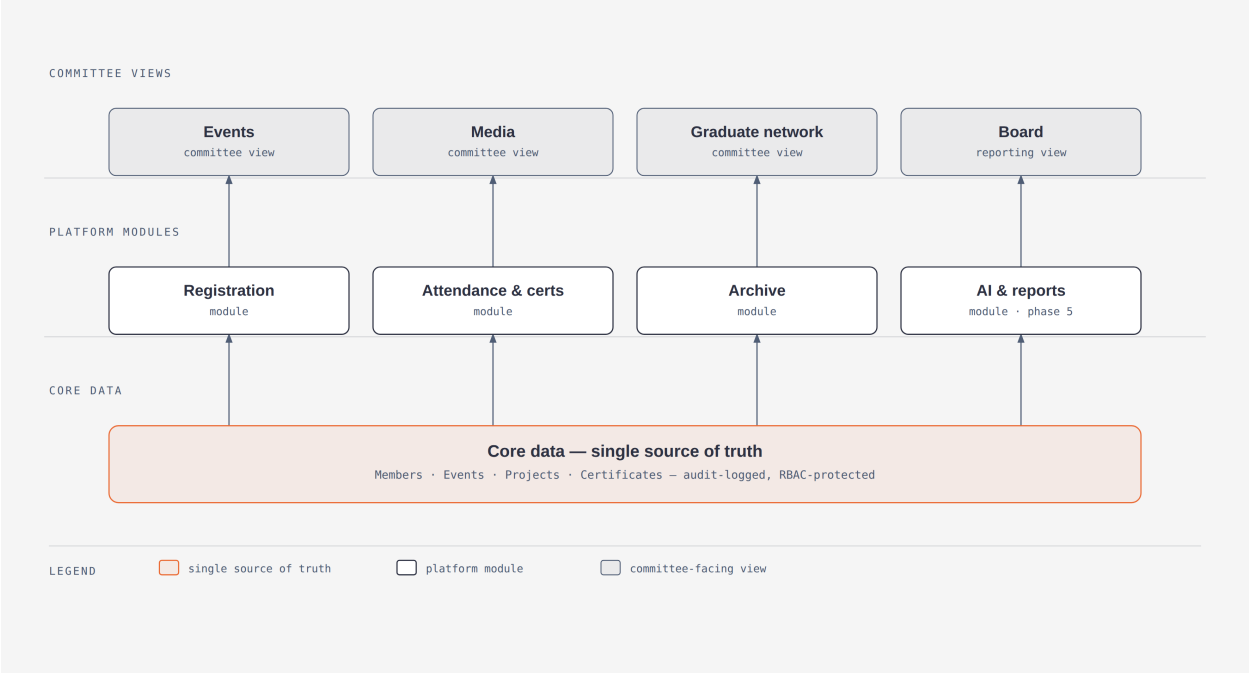


Four deliverables, one gate. Once all four are done, we review together and Phase 1 opens.

THE BIG PICTURE

The platform in one picture

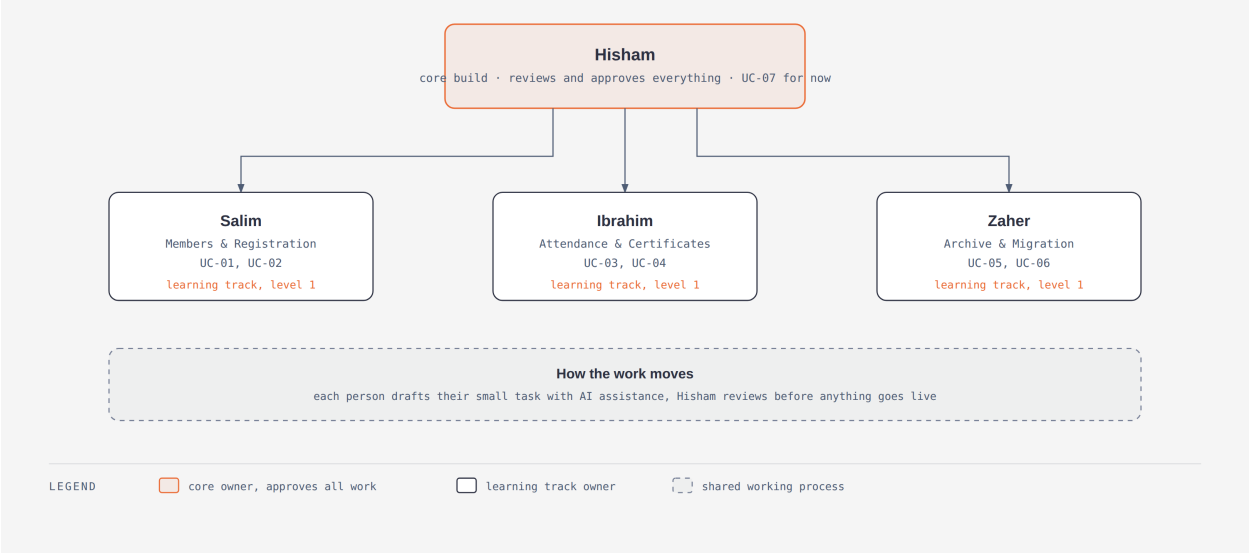
Every committee reads from the same core data. Nothing is entered twice, and nothing built this year disappears next year. Keep this picture in mind, every piece anyone builds fits into one of these boxes.



WHO OWNS WHAT

Your team, right-sized

Four people, three of them new to building software. So this isn't a structure of independent owners working alone, it's Hisham doing the core technical work and reviewing everything, while Salim, Ibrahim, and Zaher each grow into one area, one step at a time.



The graduate network (UC-07) stays with Hisham for now. It's Phase 4 work, so there's no rush to assign it, and it keeps the team from stretching into a fourth area too early.

How each person learns the work

Everyone starts at Level 1, at the same time, so nobody feels behind. Moving up happens individually, whenever Hisham decides that person's area is ready, not on a fixed schedule.

Level 1: Learn by doing small, safe tasks

No live building yet. They learn what their use case needs by sitting with Hisham, and do small AI-assisted tasks: writing test data, checking a workflow against the requirements document, drafting simple content. Nothing they touch reaches a real user.

Level 2: Draft real pieces, Hisham approves everything

They use AI tools to draft one small real piece of their area, for example Salim drafting the registration form fields. Hisham reviews it line by line before it goes anywhere near production. This is where they learn what good looks like from the corrections.

Level 3: Light independence, spot-checked

Once several drafts have been approved with few or no changes, they can make small fixes and additions on their own, still flagged to Hisham, who spot-checks instead of reviewing everything line by line.

Role assignments

Person	Area	Use cases	Starting level
Hisham	Core build, architecture, every approval	All, plus UC-07 directly	Lead
Salim	Members & Registration	UC-01, UC-02	Level 1
Ibrahim	Attendance & Certificates	UC-03, UC-04	Level 1
Zaher	Archive & Migration	UC-05, UC-06	Level 1

HOW WE WORK

Standards everyone follows

Not optional preferences. Every task, at every level, follows these so the platform stays one system, not four separate experiments.

Area	Standard
Version control	Git, feature branches, Conventional Commits (feat:, fix:, docs:)
Review	Hisham reviews everything at Level 1 and 2; spot-checks at Level 3
Data model	ER diagram reviewed and approved before any schema is written
Decisions	Any major technical choice gets a short written note (what and why)
Environments	Separate dev / staging / production, never test on real data
Documentation	Every piece ships with a short note on what it does and how it connects
Access control	Role-based permissions, committees only see and edit their own scope

WHERE THIS FITS

Six phases, one gate at a time



This is a dependency order, not a calendar. Phase 2 doesn't start until Phase 1 actually works, however long that honestly takes.

THE PLAN

Phase 0, step by step

This is the order we execute in. Each step finishes before the next one starts.

#	Step	Owner	Done when
1	Charter written & signed	Hisham	Board approves scope, mandate, sponsor
2	Requirements audit	Hisham	One pain-point per committee documented
3	Architecture blueprint	Hisham	ERD, tech stack, and decisions approved
4	Standards & infra set up	Hisham	Repo, environments, onboarding doc live
5	Roles assigned	Hisham	Salim, Ibrahim, Zaher each have one area
6	Board sign-off	Board + Hisham	Written approval, Phase 1 unlocked

Definition of done for Phase 0

- The charter is signed by the board.
- The data model (ERD) and tech stack are documented and approved.
- Salim, Ibrahim, and Zaher each have one area and are at Level 1.
- The repo, environments, and coding standards are live, not just written down.
- Everyone could explain their area's use case back to Hisham in their own words.

Once every box above is checked, Phase 1 begins: Salim starts Level 1 on member registration, with Hisham building alongside him.